Supplement: Certified Expression Intervals under Shared Segmentation Uncertainty

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This supplement specifies the atlas construction, exact count algorithm, experimental contracts and verification paths. The main manuscript contains the complete cost-representation, gluing, hard-budget and composition arguments. All count guarantees concern the retained observed molecules and the declared fixed-seam family. The external breast input is explicitly a vendor format-test dataset, rather than biological validation.

1 Continuous realization of assignments

Use coordinate t along an interface and x across it. Let m ordered boundary graphs $f_a : I \to \mathbb{R}$, $a = 0, \dots, m-1$, divide a compact corridor into $m+1$ cells. Each boundary has a constant slope limit $s_a > 0$, a constant band $[\underline{b}_a, \overline{b}_a]$, and fixed endpoint values. Adjacent boundaries satisfy

$$0 < d_a^{\min} \le f_{a+1}(t) - f_a(t) \le d_a^{\max}. \tag{1}$$

The upper bound may be absent. A rational piecewise-affine reference f^0 satisfies these geometric constraints. Exterior rails strictly beyond the bands close the outer cells.

Site i is a rectangle $[x_i^-, x_i^+] \times I_i$ in group $g(i)$; a point is a zero-size rectangle. All sites in a group share cell label c_g. Threshold bits $b_{ga} = \mathbf{1}[c_g \le a]$ satisfy $b_{ga} \le b_{g,a+1}$. For clearance $\rho > 0$, requiring the entire site to lie on its assigned side gives

$$b_{g(i),a} = 1 \Rightarrow f_a(t) \ge \ell_i = x_i^+ + \rho, \qquad b_{g(i),a} = 0 \Rightarrow f_a(t) \le u_i = x_i^- - \rho \quad (t \in I_i). \tag{2}$$

Fixed structural regions have pinned labels and no molecular reward. Nominal RNA locations use point sites. Universal-location regions use (2); they can make the source assignment inadmissible even though f^0 satisfies the geometry.

For a complete assignment c, let $\mathcal{F}(c)$ contain its realizing boundaries and define

$$D^\star(c) = \min_{f \in \mathcal{F}(c)} \sum_a \int_I |f_a(t) - f_a^0(t)|\, dt, \qquad \min \varnothing = +\infty. \tag{3}$$

This is summed interface displacement in the declared coordinates. The later scalar-ribbon construction converts it exactly to physical changed-label area counted once. For arbitrary unary molecular costs $C_g(c_g)$ and $\lambda \ge 0$, the penalized objective is $\lambda D^\star(c) + \sum_g C_g(c_g)$; a hard area budget is a different problem.

1.1 Propagation and exact feasibility

Give the boundary-index graph an edge $a \to a+1$ of weight $d_a^{\min}$ and, when finite, a reverse edge of weight $-d_a^{\max}$. Let Δ_{ab} be maximum path weight, with $\Delta_{aa} = 0$ and $-\infty$ for no path. Source feasibility excludes positive cycles. Define

$$K_{ab}(r) = \max_v \{\Delta_{av} + \Delta_{vb} - s_v r\}, \qquad r \ge 0. \tag{4}$$

Lemma 1 (Heterogeneous propagation)**.** *Every feasible family obeys $f_b(y) \ge f_a(x) + K_{ab}(|x-y|)$. This is the strongest inequality obtained by finite compositions of the stated slope and same-coordinate difference constraints.*

Proof. For any intermediate boundary v, transfer from a to v at x, travel on v to y, and transfer to b. This gives each term of (4). Conversely choose a boundary of smallest slope rate among the longitudinal portions of a composite path. Its vertical portions before and after that visit are bounded by Δ_{av}, Δ_{vb}. Total absolute longitudinal travel is at least $|x - y|$, at rates at least s_v. Hence the path cannot improve that term. The zero-distance case follows from transitive closure. □

The kernels are nonincreasing, $K_{ab}(0) = \Delta_{ab}$, and $K_{ab}(r_1 + r_2) \geq K_{av}(r_1) + K_{vb}(r_2)$. A term with rate greater than the destination rate s_b is dominated by its direct-b term; the analogous source statement holds.

A lower requirement (a, I_i, ℓ_i) is forbidden if a kernel term (d, s) to any b satisfies $\ell_i + d > \overline{b}_b$, or $\ell_i + d > f_b^0(e) + s\,\mathrm{dist}(e, I_i)$ at either endpoint e. An upper requirement (a, I_i, u_i) is forbidden if a term of K_{ba} satisfies $u_i - d < \underline{b}_b$, or $f_b^0(e) > u_i - d + s\,\mathrm{dist}(e, I_i)$. Add nesting and all fixed-label bits. Finally add

$$b_{g(i),a} \Rightarrow b_{g(j),b} \quad \text{whenever } \ell_i + K_{ab}(\mathrm{dist}(I_i, I_j)) > u_j. \tag{5}$$

These are finite unary restrictions and implications; a contradiction means an empty geometric family.

Theorem 2 (Feasible assignments)**.** *The finite restrictions characterize exactly the complete assignments realizable by the continuous family.*

Proof. Necessity follows from Lemma 1; minimum interval distance gives the largest propagated lower requirement. For sufficiency, propagate all active lower requirements, bands and fixed endpoint values into $L_b(t)$, and upper requirements into $U_b(t)$. A lower term is $\ell_i + K_{ab}(\mathrm{dist}(t, I_i))$; an upper term from a is $u_i - K_{ba}(\mathrm{dist}(t, I_i))$. Kernel composition, the triangle inequality, and (5) put every lower term below every upper term. Unary restrictions handle fixed data, so $L_b \leq U_b$. For a directed gap edge $a \to b$ of weight d, closure gives $K_{vb} \geq K_{va} + d$ and $K_{av} \geq d + K_{bv}$. Thus $L_b \geq L_a + d$ and $U_a \leq U_b - d$. Applying this to reverse edges enforces maximum gaps as well. Dominated rates preserve individual slope limits. Fixed data enforce bands and endpoint equality. Both envelope families therefore satisfy the geometry and realize the selected requirements. Nesting decodes one label per group. □

1.2 An exact cost function before molecular objectives

Theorem 3 (Assignment-wise cost representation)**.** *For rational input, a polynomial-size directed graph with assignment bits $b(c)$, helpers y, rational capacities, hard implications and known constant κ satisfies*

$$\min_y \mathrm{Cut}_{G_D}(b(c), y) + \kappa = D^\star(c) \tag{6}$$

for every feasible c. Hard-feasible cuts exist exactly for feasible assignments. For arbitrary rational unary molecular costs and rational $\lambda \geq 0$, a cut either detects infeasibility or returns an optimum and an attaining rational piecewise-affine boundary.

Proof. The family of lower difference inequalities is closed under componentwise minimum and maximum; those operations also preserve each scalar slope bound, band and endpoint. Since L, U, f^0 obey the geometry,

$$f_b^*(t) = \min\{U_b(t), \max\{L_b(t), f_b^0(t)\}\} \tag{7}$$

is jointly feasible and satisfies the selected requirements. Every realization has $L_b(t) \leq f_b(t) \leq U_b(t)$. The clamp is the nearest permitted value to $f_b^0(t)$ at every coordinate, proving simultaneous minimum displacement and (3).

An upward displacement is the maximum of nonnegative functions $[\ell_i + d - s\,\mathrm{dist}(t, I_i) - f_b^0(t)]_+$ activated by bits; downward displacements use complementary bits. Include structural requirements and source-inconsistent RNA requirements. Upward and downward contributions cannot both be positive on a feasible assignment. Split the domain at their affine-piece endpoints, zeros, source knots and pair crossings. On one slab let $h_1 \geq \cdots \geq h_k > 0$, $h_{k+1} = 0$, with S_j the labels in the first j activations. Then

$$\max_{i \text{ active}} h_i = \sum_{j=1}^{k} (h_j - h_{j+1}) \mathbf{1}[S_j \text{ contains an active bit}]. \tag{8}$$

Integrate the nonnegative affine differences exactly. An OR term has a standard helper with incoming hard implications and a terminal cost; complementary terms reverse the construction [1, 2]. Repeated labels are included once. Fixed terms are retained in κ or forced helpers. Thus minimizing over helpers gives the exact integrated clamp for each fixed $b(c)$, proving (6). Expand any unary cost as $C_g(m)+\sum_{a<m}[C_g(a)-C_g(a+1)]b_{ga}$ and shift negative terms by a known constant. Rational scaling yields integer capacities. After molecular costs and λ are chosen, each numerical hard capacity is set above the resulting total finite capacity. The fixed object is the geometric representation and its logical implications, rather than one numerical big-M for every possible future objective. A cut through a hard arc distinguishes infeasibility; (7) reconstructs the boundary. □

Graph size versus construction work. Let N count all merged RNA and structural rectangles, G groups, and $M_b = O(Nm^2)$ propagated terms on boundary b. For one polarity the untruncated terms are $g_i(t) = \alpha_i - s_i \operatorname{dist}(t, I_i)$. Their common reference changes positivity, but not relative cone order. Each pair changes order only constantly many times. An adjacent swap changes one full prefix; starting with M_b prefixes yields $O(M_b^2 + M_b)$ distinct activation sets. Simultaneous events may be resolved into adjacent swaps, repeated labels only merge sets, and zero-weight predecessor prefixes support constant-arc helpers. Consequently

$$|V| = O\left(Gm + \sum_b (M_b^2 + M_b)\right), \quad |E| = O\left(Gm + N^2m^2 + \sum_b (M_b^2 + M_b)\right). \tag{9}$$

The auxiliary contribution is $O(N^2m^5)$. Source knots still affect integration, coefficient lengths and reconstruction. Exact intersections, integrals and denominator scaling have polynomial bit complexity. An event integrator updates affected adjacent layers rather than rescanning every layer; on a J-knot reference its work is $O((M^2 + MJ + J + 1)\log(M + J + 2))$ rational-arithmetic and bitset operations, given that reference. Queueing adjacent inversions handles multiple crossings; unchanged layer integrals accumulate until the next change. This is a construction bound with operand costs, not an end-to-end tissue runtime claim. Arrangement sweeps are established tools [3].

2 Physical atlas and exact reference agreement

The reference is the original labelled raster interpreted as a union of closed pixel squares with disjoint interiors. A positive cell label is eligible when its pixel set is connected and does not meet the crop boundary. Background label zero may participate as the other side of an interface; it is not an additional biological cell. Ineligible cells, crop boundaries and unselected portions of interfaces remain fixed.

For each adjacent eligible label pair, trace shared pixel edges into paths. Split paths at vertices where continuation is ambiguous and into coordinate-monotone runs. Divide long runs at a maximum of 128 unit edges, trim one edge from each end, and retain at least four remaining edges. Rank candidates by length and then by a deterministic label/coordinate ordering. Try ribbon halfwidths $4, 2, 1, 1/2$ pixels in that order. No gene identity, transcript count, count interval or optimization outcome determines this ranking.

Let $s_x, s_y \in \{-1, 1\}$ orient a monotone run. Pixel-edge coordinates obey

$$t = s_x x + s_y y, \qquad u = s_x x - s_y y.$$

The run is exactly $u = r(t)$, with slopes $+1$ or -1 between its recorded raster vertices. Put $v = u - r(t)$. The inverse physical chart, up to its stored origin, is

$$\Phi(t, v) = \frac{p}{2}\big(s_x(t + r(t) + v),\ s_y(t - r(t) - v)\big), \qquad |\det D\Phi| = \frac{p^2}{2}.$$

The pixel size p is read from the source coordinate transformation and represented rationally. It is not replaced by a rounded display value. An accepted ribbon has $v \in [-B, B]$, allowed displacement $|h(t)| \le 3B/4$, $|h(t)-h(t')| \le |t-t'|$, and zero endpoint displacement. The RNA clearance is $\rho = 10^{-6}/p$ in chart coordinates; it is a numerical side-separation convention, rather than a calibrated physical normal clearance. These settings define a sensitivity family, not a fitted confidence region.

2.1 Acceptance and nuclear constraints

Every piece of the left/right half-ribbon is clipped against intersecting native pixels using rational polygon arithmetic. Positive-area intersections must have the declared left/right source labels. Pairwise ribbon interiors must be disjoint. A geometric spatial index reduces candidate comparisons; it does not replace the final rational intersection test. RNA coordinates are transformed through the exact chart and their nominal side must agree with the original source mask. A molecule may occur in at most one accepted patch.

A nuclear-mask pixel is labelled by the source *cell* mask at that pixel, rather than by its unrelated nucleus identifier. Clip its square to the ribbon, transform its fragments into (t, v) coordinates, and split at reference-curve knots. Over each projected interval, the maximum required left-side value or minimum right-side value supplies a conservative constant bound. Thus every original intersecting nuclear fragment retains its label. The bound may exclude additional shapes; it never permits a part of the nucleus to change owner. Structural constraints have zero additional clearance. Encoding them as shifted synthetic point/interval constraints cancels the engine's RNA clearance exactly; these encodings are not new RNA observations.

An initial nucleus-free extraction was retained as an unsuccessful coverage pilot. The final procedure keeps nuclear constraints and includes cell–background interfaces. This amendment preceded the new count calculations. It was fixed before the external transfer results. It is documented experimental ordering, not external preregistration.

2.2 Global homeomorphism

For fixed longitudinal coordinate and any admissible h, define

$$H_h(t, v) = \begin{cases} -B + (v + B)(h(t) + B)/B, & -B \le v \le 0, \\ h(t) + v(B - h(t))/B, & 0 \le v \le B. \end{cases}$$

Its transverse slopes are strictly positive because $|h| < B$. Both formulas agree at zero, map zero to h, and fix $-B, B$. Its inverse is continuous, and $h = 0$ at longitudinal endpoints makes the whole boundary trace fixed. Conjugating $(t, v) \mapsto (t, H_h(t, v))$ through Φ gives a homeomorphism of the closed physical ribbon fixing its boundary. It maps the two source sides to the requested alternatives.

Extend each map by the identity outside its ribbon. Disjoint interiors and fixed traces make the maps agree on intersections. A finite union is therefore a global continuous bijection with the corresponding piecewise inverse. The reference cell topology, connectivity, holes and junction incidences are preserved. This argument does not require deleting a complicated set of patches from a cell and hoping the remaining core is connected.

Changed-label area inside one two-label ribbon is exactly

$$A(h) = \frac{p^2}{2} \int_I |h(t)|\, dt.$$

Interiors do not overlap, so changed-label area in the atlas is the sum of these costs, counted once. At source knots the chart is piecewise affine; the finite kink set has zero area. An arbitrary curved coordinate chart would require its own Jacobian and is not silently covered by this calculation.

3 Exact assignment-cost function and graph construction

In an ordered corridor, each boundary has a slope bound, band and endpoint values; adjacent boundaries have constant minimum and optional maximum separations. All finite rational data are binary encoded. The source satisfies the geometric constraints. RNA-location rectangles and pinned structural regions induce lower or upper interval requirements depending on their discrete owner thresholds.

The maximum-path closure Δ of same-coordinate separation inequalities yields

$$K_{ab}(r) = \max_c \{\Delta_{ac} + \Delta_{cb} - s_c r\}.$$

Every finite sequence of permitted longitudinal and cross-boundary steps is bounded by such a term: choose the least slope on that path, bound its total travel below by the endpoint distance, and its remaining directed weights above by the corresponding closure weights. This gives the complete propagated lower/upper restrictions, including both directions of each finite maximum gap.

The selected lower family L, upper family U, and reference f^0 obey the same geometric difference inequalities. The finite conflict tests imply $L \le U$. Minimum and maximum preserve these inequalities and each scalar slope bound, so

$$f_b^*(t) = \min\{U_b(t), \max\{L_b(t), f_b^0(t)\}\}$$

is a jointly feasible family and is pointwise nearest to the reference. This simultaneous attainment establishes the ownerwise minimum $D^*(c)$, not just a lower bound on independently chosen coordinates.

3.1 Integrated layers and the helper bound

In one direction, source-relative excursions are maxima of active flat-top cones. On an analytic interval with ordered positive heights $h_1 \ge \cdots \ge h_q > 0$, set $h_{q+1} = 0$. Their activated maximum equals

$$\sum_{j=1}^{q} (h_j - h_{j+1})\, \mathbf{1}[\text{at least one activation among the first } j \text{ occurs}].$$

Integrate the affine differences exactly. Repeated cones carrying the same molecular bit use that bit once; complementary activations encode the opposite direction. Fixed-positive constraints contribute a mandatory constant or forced helper. Standard implication/OR gadgets then preserve the exact integral for every hard-feasible owner vector. Finite hard capacities exceed the total finite capacity for the requested objective.

For M untruncated flat-top cones, a pair changes order only constantly many times. Starting with M prefixes, each adjacent swap introduces at most one additional prefix. Thus the union contains $O(M^2 + M)$ distinct sets. A common reference changes positivity, not cone order. Resolve simultaneous events into adjacent swaps and retain a deterministic tie rule on coincidence intervals. Mapping cone indices to repeated activation labels cannot enlarge the family. A set can use a predecessor prefix plus its last newly added label; retaining zero-weight predecessors keeps the arc count proportional to the number of sets.

If $M_b = O(Nm^2)$ includes all propagated molecular and structural constraints, the graph has

$$|V| = O\left(Gm + \sum_b (M_b^2 + M_b)\right), \quad |E| = O\left(Gm + N^2m^2 + \sum_b (M_b^2 + M_b)\right).$$

The auxiliary contribution is $O(N^2m^5)$. Source knots, intersections and coefficient denominator lengths still affect construction and encoding. Event-driven accumulation can integrate a direction's coefficients in $O((M^2 + MJ + J + 1)\log(M + J + 2))$ rational-arithmetic and bitset operations for a J-knot reference. This integration-stage statement is distinct from the final graph-size bound and from total bit complexity. These inherited optional-optimization results are not retimed in the present atlas study.

4 Critical-height count algorithm

4.1 Input contract and common mesh

The implemented count chain accepts one boundary, fixed structural regions, rational piecewise-affine source, slope/band/endpoints, and one point per free RNA group. It rejects a free group spanning several locations or an interval: its owner would need to be remembered across nodes. Fixed groups may contain many structural rectangles because their labels are known. Group scores are nonnegative integers for each owner, with an integer fixed offset. Atlas, source-observation and saved exact-geometry identities are checked before certification; the count chain checks the raw point-input contract before compilation.

Collect all affine pieces that any canonical realization can select: lower and upper cones for every possible point owner, fixed constraints, bands, endpoints and source. Include all piece endpoints, observation locations

and same-boundary intersections in a common mesh. Omit crossings outside the forced envelope only when they cannot be a canonical switch. At every node, candidate heights are function values inside the forced range and outside every observation's clearance gap.

For any complete feasible assignment, its canonical minimizer selects affine pieces between mesh events and crosses the source only at events. Its nodal trapezoidal area is exactly its continuous area. Conversely a feasible candidate path interpolates into a feasible boundary, and its trapezoid upper-bounds that interpolant's area. Retaining the canonical minimizer proves equality of minimum area at *each count*, not equality for every interpolant.

4.2 Recurrence, sliding minima and reconstruction

Let V_j be the sorted heights at time t_j, $z_j(v)$ the score of points observed at that time, and

$$a_j(v) = w_j|v - f^0(t_j)|, \qquad w_j = \tfrac{1}{2}[(t_j - t_{j-1}) + (t_{j+1} - t_j)],$$

with missing endpoint intervals omitted. Each point contributes once. Pinned-group scores enter the initial offset. The least prefix cost satisfies

$$F_j(v, q) = a_j(v) + \min_{\substack{u \in V_{j-1} \\ |u-v| \le s(t_j - t_{j-1})}} F_{j-1}(u, q - z_j(v)).$$

Initialize with first-node cost and score. For each predecessor count, scan candidate heights in increasing order. Insert each permitted predecessor into a monotone deque, discard dominated costs at its back, and discard expired heights at its front. The front gives the least predecessor cost. Both ends of the height-compatibility interval move monotonically, so one node transition takes $O(H_{j-1} + H_j)$ work per count. Backpointers reconstruct a complete owner vector and boundary, which are checked against the original continuous constraints and exactly integrated area.

If the variable score range is W, dynamic-programming work is $O((W + 1)\sum_j H_j)$ and full backpointer storage has the same order. Value-only rolling storage can be smaller. With P explicit affine pieces, a conservative mesh bound is $O(P^2 + P)$ events, at most $O(P)$ heights per event, and $O((W + 1)P^3)$ dynamic-programming work. For explicit unit transcripts, W is at most the number of scored molecules. Binary-compressed multiplicities instead give a pseudo-polynomial dependence on W. Rational operand lengths, candidate preparation and output serialization remain separate costs.

The implementation raises a resource-limit outcome instead of marking an incomplete spectrum exact. The reference is geometrically feasible but need not realize every point's original owner at zero cost. A positive mandatory-area test exercises that distinction. Single-copy source-feasible queries use the cheaper implication-closure fast path; all multicopy queries in the end-to-end count-chain census use the algorithm above.

4.3 An explicit unit-molecule penalty gap

Use source zero on $[0, 30]$, slope one, band $[-4, 4]$ and clearance $\rho = 1/10$. At centers 5, 15 and 25 place respectively 2, 3 and 3 distinct point RNAs. Point j in a cluster has $(t, x) = (\text{center} + j/100,\ h - j/100 - \rho)$, with $h = 2, 3, 3$. The slope and clearance force a common owner within each cluster; their leading tents dominate, and clusters have disjoint positive supports. Full owner enumeration gives eight feasible vectors and spectrum

$$\{(0, 0), (2, 4), (3, 9), (5, 13), (6, 18), (8, 22)\}$$

(count, area). At area ten the largest attainable count is three. Every penalty bound is at least four: for $\mu \le 1/3$ the count-eight state gives $8 - 12\mu \ge 4$, and for $\mu \ge 1/3$ the count-two state gives $2 + 6\mu \ge 4$. At $1/3$ equality holds. All molecules are unit observations at distinct coordinates; no succinct bundle encoding is used. The count chain recovers the unsupported count-three outcome.

5 Composition, baselines and joint predicates

For a cell–gene pair with source count n_0, each incident patch supplies minimum physical area $S_i(d)$ for count *change* d. Use

$$S(q) = \min_{d_1+\cdots+d_r=q} \sum_i S_i(d_i), \qquad [L, U] = \left[\min_{S(q)\le\delta} (n_0 + q),\ \max_{S(q)\le\delta} (n_0 + q) \right].$$

Using changes prevents counting fixed exterior molecules more than once. Zero-relevant patches can stay at their zero-cost source. A minimizing trace yields compatible local witnesses, and the global homeomorphism proves attainability. Restricting any allowed global state to its patches proves the reverse inequality. There is one budget for the complete atlas, not one independent allowance per patch.

The outer baseline lets every individually affordable RNA choose a feasible owner independently. It can combine incompatible changes or overspend the budget; its interval is an outer bound. The additive inner baseline retains exact local feasibility, charges every changed RNA its singleton minimum (including collateral genes), and composes these costs. Under zero-cost source admissibility, this sum upper-bounds shared area, so budget feasibility is an inner approximation. An omitted endpoint is not a false exclusion made by the exact method. A zero discrepancy does not prove the two models identical for other objectives.

For co-detection, retain a two-dimensional score and compose vector spectra. Marginal endpoints need not coexist. The tested predicate is $N_{g_1} > 0$ and $N_{g_2} > 0$, classified as always, never or variable over the budgeted spectrum. This is an expression-detection statement, not a cell-type, signaling, statistical differential-expression or false-discovery claim.

6 Data, extraction and complete experimental denominators

The lung inputs are two 200-micrometre lung crops of a public Xenium lung-cancer specimen, containing 7,370 retained Q20 measured-gene RNA records. Their 42 historical overlapping corridors are not used as independent atlas patches. The current atlas is re-extracted from the source masks, with whole reference-cell containment checked directly.

The breast inputs are the two previously acquired source crops in the public workflow artifact identified in the provenance record. The artifact's SHA-256 is `f53bee7d82a385a320c14a180049e66bf6f60963dda8d7a75574fda90c28febf`. It contains 81,182 retained RNA records and corresponding masks. The source is the vendor's two-field-of-view breast format-test dataset. The vendor explicitly cautions against biological conclusions from those trimmed test data. This is a fixed-rule external-data transfer test, not newly measured ground truth or a held-out biological cohort. The data had been analyzed in prior workflows and were not independently preregistered.

	Lung 1	Lung 2	Breast 1	Breast 2
Retained RNA	5,847	1,523	43,366	37,816
Complete reference cells	79	74	253	214
Accepted patches	276	268	928	780
Editable RNA	627	118	4,789	3,473
RNA-bearing patches	190	72	760	628
Maximum RNA per patch	19	6	39	33
Editable reference edges	7,093	8,728	28,606	24,306
All incident reference edges	10,756	12,408	43,331	37,132

Table 1: Complete extraction census. Coverage denominators include incident edges with ineligible neighboring cells. Refer to the machine-readable coverage record for per-cell lengths and fractions.

The two lung crops have disjoint complete-cell identifiers, as do the two breast crops. Five eligible lung cells have no retained positive gene count and no editable relevant molecule; their rows are implicit zeros in the

supplied matrix index. The interval CSV is sparse over every positive-source or editable cell–gene key. Absent entries are zero only within the explicitly recorded panel/observed-gene universe, retained observations and atlas identity. They are not biological-absence calls.

All eight budgets $0, 0.05, 0.1, 0.25, 0.5, 1, 2, 4\,\mu\mathrm{m}^2$ are reported. There are 3,304 lung and 22,976 breast cell–gene spectra, yielding 26,432 and 183,808 unique interval rows. The exact outputs are fixed by one atlas per crop; no interval is averaged or minimized across overlapping models. Source counts outside editable ribbons remain part of every cell's count.

6.1 Budget-specific simple-baseline comparisons

Area budget	Lung variable	Breast variable	Breast outer tightened	Breast inner misses
0	0	0	0	0
0.05	366	3,684	84	11
0.1	429	4,414	80	25
0.25	524	5,259	61	29
0.5	524	5,259	3	3
1	524	5,259	0	0
2	524	5,259	0	0
4	524	5,259	0	0

Table 2: Counts out of 3,304 or 22,976 entries per budget. Lung outer improvements comprise four rows at 0.1; the two lung inner misses occur at 0.1 and 0.25. Simple baselines agree with the majority of exact endpoints.

In breast crop 1, cell 81's LDHB source count is 22. Its minimum attaining count 17 is exactly

$$\frac{19773488331902675966995674 29}{40850916262281216000000000 00} \simeq 0.48404026497\,\mu\mathrm{m}^2.$$

The global trace changes three LDHB molecules through one patch and two through another, plus one collateral KRT8 molecule. A third incident LDHB patch remains unchanged. At budget 0.25 the exact interval is $[19, 23]$ versus marginal $[17, 23]$; at 0.5 it is $[17, 23]$ versus additive-inner $[18, 23]$. The case is an illustrative selection from the complete output, not a predefined biological hypothesis.

6.2 Question denominators and endpoint saturation

On the original eight budgets, 46 lung and 1,026 breast cell–gene questions have marginal width at least two for some budget. Exact geometry tightens four and 203 of these questions, affecting four of 153 lung cells and 139 of 467 breast cells. These question and cell denominators complement the repeated-row counts; no original row or null result is removed. A question is counted once if at least one budget tightens an endpoint.

In the original atlas the largest support halfwidth is four chart units. The chart displacement has Euclidean norm $p|h|/\sqrt{2}$, hence its maximum allowed value is $3pB/(4\sqrt{2}) \simeq 0.4508\,\mu\mathrm{m}$. This is a cap in the coordinate model, rather than a calibrated error scale. The lung and breast spectra attain their extreme endpoints by areas approximately 0.240525 and 0.573939. Constant non-singleton totals from area 0.25 therefore indicate occupancy saturation earlier than complete endpoint saturation.

7 Physical-width sensitivity with fixed selection rules

The prospective analysis record fixes required support halfwidths $r = 0.5, 1, 2, 3\,\mu\mathrm{m}$, the original arc construction, run ordering, endpoint seams, slope one, nuclear constraints and clearance, and the area grid

$$0, .005, .01, .025, .05, .1, .15, .2, .25, .375, .5, .75, 1, 2, 4, 8, 16.$$

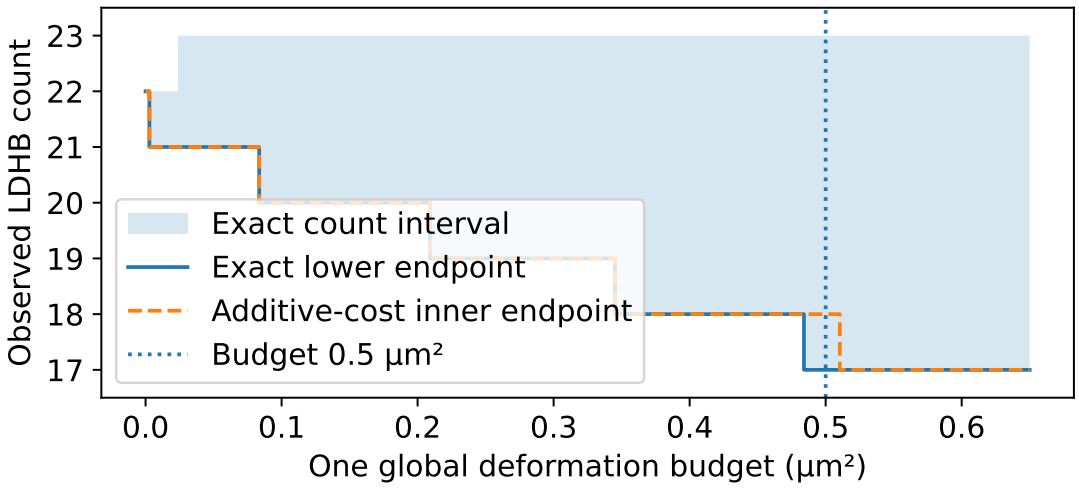


Figure 1: The complete LDHB count-spectrum example under unchanged atlas geometry. Step changes follow exact rational minimum areas, rather than interpolation between sampled optimization outputs. The inner comparison can miss an attainable endpoint; the outer comparison can combine individually affordable but jointly over-budget changes.

The study is a declared sensitivity analysis on already available inputs. Its protocol predates the width-dependent extraction and count outcomes; it is not a new held-out biological study. Each run uses $B = \lfloor 4\sqrt{2}r/p \rfloor/4$ and accepts only that width. Rejected patches do not fall back to narrower widths. Longer arcs keep priority and all original coordinate tie rules. Consequently each width defines a separate fixed-seam atlas; the atlases need not be nested.

Every rejected candidate and accepted patch is retained in extraction summaries. Rejection can follow third labels, nuclei inconsistent with required clearance, chart geometry, intersections with earlier selected ribbons, or other declared acceptance conditions. All eligible source cells remain in count denominators, including those without editable patches. Each accepted patch is checked against exact raster-side intersections, all molecular source owners, structural constraints and disjoint interiors.

The last endpoint-saturation areas across Adaptive, 0.5, 1, 2 and 3 are, respectively, 0.240525, 0.154063, 1.497699, 3.090472 and 4.878380 for lung; and 0.573939, 0.376462, 1.281168, 5.095884 and 13.782726 for breast. Larger support permits larger movement, but fewer patches fit the same segmentation. The largest local gene multiplicity is 17; the largest patch contains 136 retained molecules. None of the eight new count runs terminates unresolved.

For like-for-like budget comparisons, the original adaptive-width spectra are also projected onto the 17-budget grid. This uses unchanged rational minima and individually affordable-transfer minima, and every original CSV row matches its earlier value exactly. On this finer grid, 12 of 46 lung and 361 of 1,026 breast questions tighten, versus the primary eight-grid results of 4 of 46 and 203 of 1,026. These are grid-dependent counts of transient differences, not additional biological observations. New width columns use the same fine grid.

	Lung			Breast format-test		
Area	Variable	Width sum	Endpoints changed	Variable	Width sum	Endpoints changed
0	0	0	0	0	0	0
0.05	366	380	366	3684	4279	3684
0.1	429	451	70	4414	5339	1028
0.25	524	572	120	5259	6754	1350
0.5	524	572	0	5259	6820	61
1	524	572	0	5259	6823	3
2	524	572	0	5259	6823	0
4	524	572	0	5259	6823	0

Table 3: Primary eight-budget occupancy, summed widths and number of cell–gene intervals whose endpoints change from the preceding displayed budget. A constant non-singleton total can coexist with further endpoint widening.

Support halfwidth	Displacement cap (μm)	Edge coverage (%) Lung	Breast	Lung Proseg reach (%)	Breast nuclear reach (%)
Adaptive	0.451	68.3	65.8	6.6	16.2
0.5	0.366	45.1	44.6	4.3	11.2
1	0.733	33.8	34.6	5.5	14.8
2	1.493	23.5	24.7	4.5	14.6
3	2.226	16.9	17.8	3.8	12.2

Table 4: Required physical support halfwidths are rounded down to quarter chart units. The cap is $3pB/(4\sqrt{2})$; actual feasibility also depends on other constraints. Reach is the fraction of changed reference counts attainable at any budget, with fixed denominators across families.

Area (μm^2)	Adaptive	0.5	1	2	3
0	0	0	0	0	0
0.005	141	78	61	27	24
0.01	194	110	84	44	36
0.025	287	165	118	57	48
0.05	366	227	161	81	72
0.1	429	301	224	127	107
0.15	484	342	265	160	136
0.2	524	342	299	181	162
0.25	524	342	320	194	172
0.375	524	342	370	226	196
0.5	524	342	414	261	218
0.75	524	342	427	298	250
1	524	342	427	326	268
2	524	342	427	379	307
4	524	342	427	388	329
8	524	342	427	388	341
16	524	342	427	388	341

Table 5: Lung: non-singleton intervals on the common 17-budget grid. Column labels after Adaptive are required physical support halfwidths in micrometres. The numbers of question entries for the five families are 3304, 3216, 3298, 3403, 3424.

Area (μm^2)	Adaptive	0.5	1	2	3
0	0/0	0/0	0/0	0/0	0/0
0.005	0/0	0/0	0/0	0/0	0/0
0.01	1/3	1/2	0/2	0/0	0/0
0.025	0/8	0/2	0/2	0/0	0/0
0.05	0/14	0/2	0/2	0/0	0/0
0.1	4/26	2/8	3/9	4/7	1/4
0.15	5/35	3/14	2/15	2/12	2/9
0.2	4/46	0/14	4/24	5/17	3/10
0.25	0/46	0/14	1/27	0/18	0/11
0.375	0/46	0/14	4/31	2/19	0/11
0.5	0/46	0/14	5/38	3/26	2/17
0.75	0/46	0/14	2/40	3/28	1/17
1	0/46	0/14	2/40	1/28	0/19
2	0/46	0/14	0/40	2/41	1/28
4	0/46	0/14	0/40	0/41	0/31
8	0/46	0/14	0/40	0/41	0/36
16	0/46	0/14	0/40	0/41	0/36

Table 6: Lung: tightened cell–gene questions / questions with marginal width at least two at each budget. Zero over zero denotes no eligible comparison, not a measured zero effect rate. Each question can recur at multiple budgets.

Area (μm^2)	Adaptive	0.5	1	2	3
0	0	0	0	0	0
0.005	1431	915	768	514	395
0.01	1927	1275	1071	742	557
0.025	2807	1944	1594	1124	834
0.05	3684	2640	2165	1556	1183
0.1	4414	3465	2817	2049	1583
0.15	4896	3852	3254	2376	1808
0.2	5226	3852	3563	2607	2002
0.25	5259	3852	3850	2830	2167
0.375	5259	3852	4411	3278	2508
0.5	5259	3852	4770	3545	2711
0.75	5259	3852	4856	3951	3054
1	5259	3852	4856	4225	3258
2	5259	3852	4856	4814	3670
4	5259	3852	4856	4876	3962
8	5259	3852	4856	4876	4013
16	5259	3852	4856	4876	4013

Table 7: Breast format-test: non-singleton intervals on the common 17-budget grid. Column labels after Adaptive are required physical support halfwidths in micrometres. The numbers of question entries for the five families are 22976, 22538, 23013, 23687, 23772.

Area (μm^2)	Adaptive	0.5	1	2	3
0	0/0	0/0	0/0	0/0	0/0
0.005	9/77	5/30	2/17	0/9	0/5
0.01	21/147	7/66	3/42	3/19	1/8
0.025	50/301	26/159	14/107	11/63	1/23
0.05	84/516	39/289	23/209	12/127	7/64
0.1	80/706	76/469	52/346	39/227	23/142
0.15	135/900	89/598	91/492	55/331	29/212
0.2	127/1021	24/598	82/579	46/383	29/249
0.25	61/1026	4/598	110/674	74/452	47/291
0.375	14/1026	1/598	147/833	91/564	51/371
0.5	3/1026	0/598	148/959	91/651	56/430
0.75	0/1026	0/598	52/990	124/780	85/528
1	0/1026	0/598	8/990	125/873	86/605
2	0/1026	0/598	0/990	121/1102	83/773
4	0/1026	0/598	0/990	8/1134	67/878
8	0/1026	0/598	0/990	0/1134	2/900
16	0/1026	0/598	0/990	0/1134	0/900

Table 8: Breast format-test: tightened cell–gene questions / questions with marginal width at least two at each budget. Zero over zero denotes no eligible comparison, not a measured zero effect rate. Each question can recur at multiple budgets.

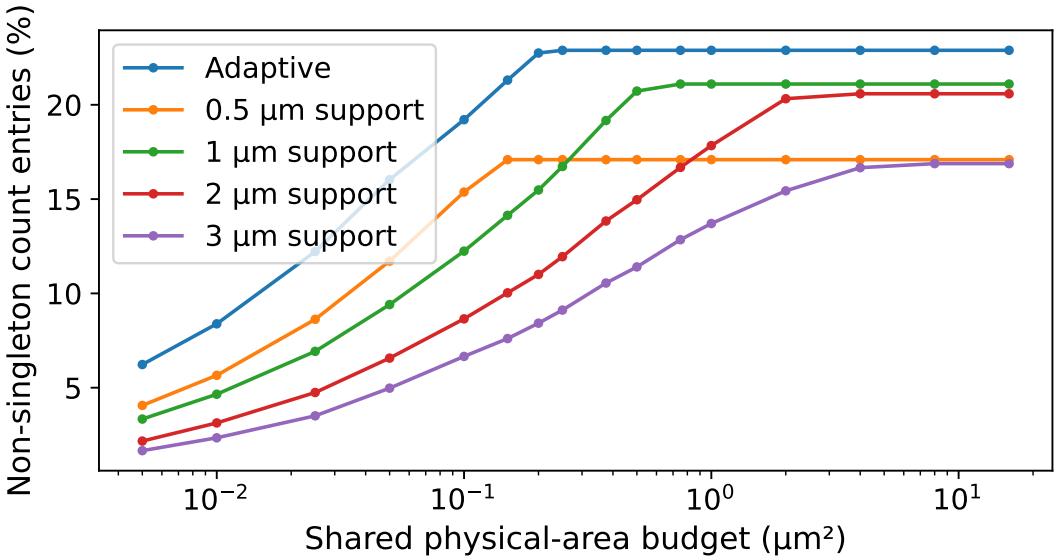


Figure 2: Breast format-test interval occupancy under all five separately extracted families. Each denominator is the complete positive-or-editable question set for that family. Width and budget change different aspects of the uncertainty model.

8 Reference segmentations and consistent reach denominators

8.1 Image-only nuclear reference

The image-only reference assigns each retained RNA to the nearest labelled nuclear pixel within five physical micrometres, or to background. Nuclear pixels carry their source cell-mask label. RNA coordinates stay fixed. A five-micrometre crop-edge guard excludes points whose nearest nucleus could lie outside the observed crop. This is a deterministic comparison rule, separate from Proseg and from an anatomical truth standard.

8.2 Proseg executions

Proseg 3.2.0 was run on the two lung crops. The initial default-factorization run on crop 1 failed during feature selection with an empty-input error. One completed stochastic run per crop used factorization disabled; remaining sampler settings were 200 burn-in iterations, 200 sampling iterations and 50 hill-climb steps, with two requested threads. Diffusion and source reassignment remained enabled. This version exposes no seed argument. Commands, input/output hashes, exclusions and the initial failed log are preserved alongside the raw results. We reanalyzed those outputs; the width study does not represent new Proseg runs.

Proseg execution quantity	Lung crop 1	Lung crop 2
Input RNA	5,847	1,523
Output RNA	5,774	1,482
Excluded RNA	73	41
Changed source owner	3,242	765
Output background/unassigned	2,484	1,335
Verified nonzero output-count entries	1,443	67

Table 9: Independent ingestion and count-matrix reconstruction of the Proseg executions. Small clipped crops omit surrounding tissue and can omit nuclear transcripts needed for cell initialization; high background assignment, particularly in crop 2, limits any accuracy interpretation.

The check joins exact transcript identifiers, verifies gene names and source assignments, maps Proseg cell labels using the original-cell mapping, and treats the output background flag explicitly. Observed-coordinate serialization residuals are at most 0.000243 and 0.000485 micrometres, respectively. Every saved sparse count entry is reconstructed exactly from the returned assignments. This arithmetic check is independent of the original comparison script; source data and Proseg executions are shared.

8.3 Countwise reach and assignment-vector exclusion

All five width families use a common set of comparison keys per reference. Retained transcripts are intersected by exact identifier. Keys whose source count involves an excluded transcript are removed. If a missing transcript is editable in any compared atlas, its gene is also excluded for every candidate destination cell in that patch. These exclusions are applied to every width; all remaining reference and source counts use the same retained observations. Thus denominators remain fixed across widths, and missing Proseg records or crop-edge nuclear exclusions cannot masquerade as changes.

The common comparison has 2,798 changed lung Proseg count keys, 1,114 changed lung nuclear keys and 10,965 changed breast nuclear keys. These differ from the original adaptive-only nuclear comparison (1,128 and 11,151 changed keys) because the new exclusion guard covers the union of editable observations over every width. Included/excluded keys and reasons are supplied explicitly.

At each budget a reference count is attainable exactly when its count-specific minimum area is within budget. Unbounded-budget reach tests membership in the entire finite count spectrum. Main Table 3 gives the latter results; all 17 finite budgets are exported. The complete reference assignment vector is ruled out in each crop at every width by at least one changed fixed RNA or unavailable destination. This exclusion is

stronger than merely observing that some count misses its interval. Conversely, countwise inclusion cannot establish a jointly realizable reference matrix.

A widening ribbon need not improve aggregate reach because its required support removes other patches. The observed reductions are results of the stated extractor and fixed-seam family, rather than evidence that Proseg or nuclear expansion is inaccurate. Anatomical coverage would require independently justified true owners or boundaries and an appropriate calibration design.

8.4 Co-detection in the primary atlas

The three tested pairs are EPCAM/PTPRC, EPCAM/CD3D and EPCAM/PECAM1. The original lung census contains 150 cell/pair questions at eight budgets; the breast census contains 1,148. Of seven lung source EPCAM/PTPRC positives, two become removable by budget 0.25. Of 48 breast source positives, two become removable. Other tested positives persist under the primary family. The vector spectra add no exclusion beyond marginal intervals on these inputs. Neither outcome alone establishes whether co-detection reflects a cell state, doublet or leakage. These primary-family records are unchanged and are separate from the width study.

9 Validation and resource measurements

The independent scalar reference uses Fraction arithmetic but imports none of the production implication, envelope, integrated-layer, min-cut or count-chain routines. It recomputes the minimum for every target assignment, then uses Cartesian products for global truth. Inputs and their extraction remain shared. Continuous witnesses have a further direct slope, band, owner, nuclear and rational-area check.

Check	Lung	Breast format test
Independent local gene spectra	706	7,068
Target binary assignments	1,498	17,542
Local witness records	1,101	11,594
Global spectra	3,304	22,976
Cartesian tuples	3,905	32,730
Global attaining count witnesses	3,876	29,799
Unique budget intervals	26,432	183,808
Exact half-ribbon/pixel checks	31,642	105,824
Relevant ribbon-pair checks	491	1,602
Nuclear pixel fragments	6,609	42,732

Table 10: All checks completed without discrepancies. Counts are computational checks on repeated model inputs, not biological replicate counts.

The count-chain test suite additionally compares 201 scalar spectra on 100 generated systems, tests 80 nonflat models against 1,644 exhaustive assignments, verifies positive mandatory deformation and rejection of free interval-valued RNA, and checks the explicit eight-unit gap. All 944 multicopy local gene questions from both data collections agree with independently enumerated spectra. A full hybrid reanalysis uses the chain for all multicopy genes and closure for single-copy genes; every global minimum area and every interval CSV row matches the separately checked enumerated calculation. The transversely monotone gluing map passes inverse, trace, chart roundtrip and independent polygon-area checks.

9.1 Width-study checks

All eight width analyses completed, giving 106,351 global spectra and 1,807,967 interval rows. Local attaining boundaries were checked in continuous coordinates during computation. A separate composition routine

reconstructed every global spectrum and checked 131,376 attaining traces, including source counts, local contribution signs, total area and unique transcript support. Every interval row was then recomputed from its exact spectrum and compared with its marginal outer bound.

Independent scalar enumeration checks a deterministic hash-selected sample of up to 32 multicopy questions per setting, restricted to two–six target copies: 246 spectra and 1,628 target assignments in total. No sample reaches its 15-second resource limit; every minimum agrees. These sampled local checks are not presented as independent enumeration of all new local optima. The new forced-owner preprocessing is additionally tested on 80 generated models: 160 spectra, 773 target assignments and 287 witnesses agree among unpruned chain, pruned chain and separate scalar enumeration. Preprocessing substitutes only hard-implication consequences; it changes no feasible owner vector.

A single process per width computes its complete spectra with a 60-second local chain allowance. Execution times in these simultaneous experiments are resource records rather than repeated comparative timing estimates. Source ingestion, masks and prepared atlas geometry remain shared dependencies. The repeated scaling study below is retained separately.

9.2 Count-chain scaling

The fixed constructed family has flat source, slope one, equal flipped height $h = 1/4$, site spacing $d = 1/10$, clearance $1/1000$, a containing band and endpoints outside all tents. The minimum for $k \geq 1$ changes is

$$A_k = h^2 + (k-1)(hd - d^2/4), \qquad A_0 = 0,$$

attained by k consecutive sites. For arbitrary selected sites, each additional separation contributes at least the adjacent-site area increment, which proves the lower bound. This analytical family is a correctness/scaling test, not a difficult problem for every possible specialized algorithm.

RNA	Count levels	Mesh nodes	Height candidates	Visited states	Median total(s)
16	17	111	1,154	8,112	0.465
32	33	207	2,370	35,104	1.574
64	65	399	4,802	147,456	7.138
128	129	783	9,666	605,632	42.206

Table 11: Three fresh sequential processes per size. Total includes preparation, dynamic programming, all witness reconstruction and continuous checks. No limit is reached.

The 128-RNA totals range from 40.189 to 42.704 seconds. Median mesh compilation is approximately 2.033 seconds and dynamic programming plus all witness output/checking approximately 40.152 seconds; separate medians need not sum exactly. The tested limits are 300,000 retained candidate heights, one million visited states, 60 seconds for preparation, 90 seconds for dynamic programming, and 160 seconds for a complete process. Requested single-thread environment variables are recorded, but the arithmetic is Python integer/Fraction work. Peak whole-process RSS at the largest size is approximately 205 MiB and includes imports. Raw process records contain the exact environment and wall/memory measurements.

10 Reproduction, data rights and assistance

The prepared-input exact workflow uses Python's standard library. Geometry extraction, raster reference analysis and plotting additionally use the declared analysis dependencies. The main commands are:

```
python atlas_cli.py verify-manifest
python release/restore_results.py
python atlas_cli.py showcase --output run/showcase.json
python atlas_cli.py validate
python analysis/reach/audit_proseg.py
python analysis/reach/check_outputs.py
python analysis/reach/report.py
```

The README lists separate commands for each main table and figure, the original full count computations and each width-specific recomputation. Compressed result files are restored only after their stored and expanded checksums agree. Source packages retain all original and new spectra, witnesses, comparison keys, Proseg records, selection rules and reference masks. Scientific validation is separate from historical timing measurements.

The GeoCert software is released under the MIT License. Original 10x data retain CC BY 4.0 attribution and the breast format-test limitation. Proseg retains its upstream rights; its executable is not redistributed. Source code, inputs and exact results for the 1.1.0 companion are publicly archived at `https://github.com/arnavperam/geocert/tree/6581f628a5ac8fb83629f9e0dee0ffa4d685375d/recomb2027-atlas`. This immutable source revision is distinguished from the separately rebuilt PDF artifacts in the release record.

Generative AI assisted mathematical development, code, experiments, checking and drafting. The named author is responsible for the submitted claims and their explanation. Separate computational checks are described by the primitives they share; they do not constitute independent biological validation or external mathematical certification.

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